Count by hands

How a Hand Works

Name _____ Date _____

Show your thinking with numbers, marks, or words.

1. Little Wonderer counts fingers by fives, one hand at a time. What number comes next?

5, 10, 15, ___

Show your thinking.

2. Each thumb has 2 bones. Big Wonderer counts thumb bones by twos. What comes next?

4, 6, 8, ___

Show your thinking.

3. Two hands have 10 fingertips. They count fingertips by tens. What comes next?

30, 40, 50, ___

Show your thinking.

Count by hands

How a Hand Works

Name _____ Date _____

Show your thinking with numbers, marks, or words.

4. The little one counts string pulls in twos. What number is missing?

12, 14, ___, 18

Show your thinking.

5. They trace 5 strings on each hand outline. What number is missing?

25, ___, 35, 40

Show your thinking.

6. A jar holds elastic cords in bundles of 10. What number is missing?

50, 60, ___, 80

Show your thinking.

WONDER DAILY

How a Hand Works

A hand on strings

A mechanical hand toy stands open with five strings at the wrist. What inside a real hand works like it?

Bones in a row

Each finger has three small bones in a line, and the thumb has two. One whole hand holds 27 bones.

A string pulls

Forearm muscles pull long tendons, like strings. Tendons pull finger bones, and loops keep them close, like the toy's loops.

Where fingers bend

Joints are where bones meet. Finger joints fold like door hinges. The thumb's base joint lets it swing across the palm.

String to finger

Pull each toy string and match it to a finger. Then curl a real finger and feel the forearm move.

Opening again

Muscles only pull, never push. Tendons on the back of the hand pull fingers straight again. Toys may use elastic.

Make a little book

1 Fold it into 8 boxes. Open it flat.

2 Fold short end to short end. Cut the thick line. Open it.

3 Fold the long way, pictures out. Push the ends in.

4 Fold into a book. Page 1 goes on the front!

Explain a hand clue in your words

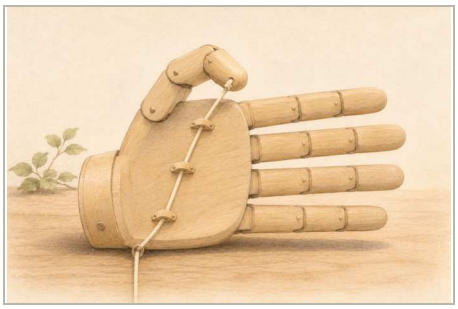
How a Hand Works · Curiosity day

Name _____ Date _____

Choose one picture. Say your idea first, then draw or write it.



Bones in a row



A string pulls



Opening again

Draw a hand outline. Mark the bones in one finger, one tendon, and the joints where it bends.

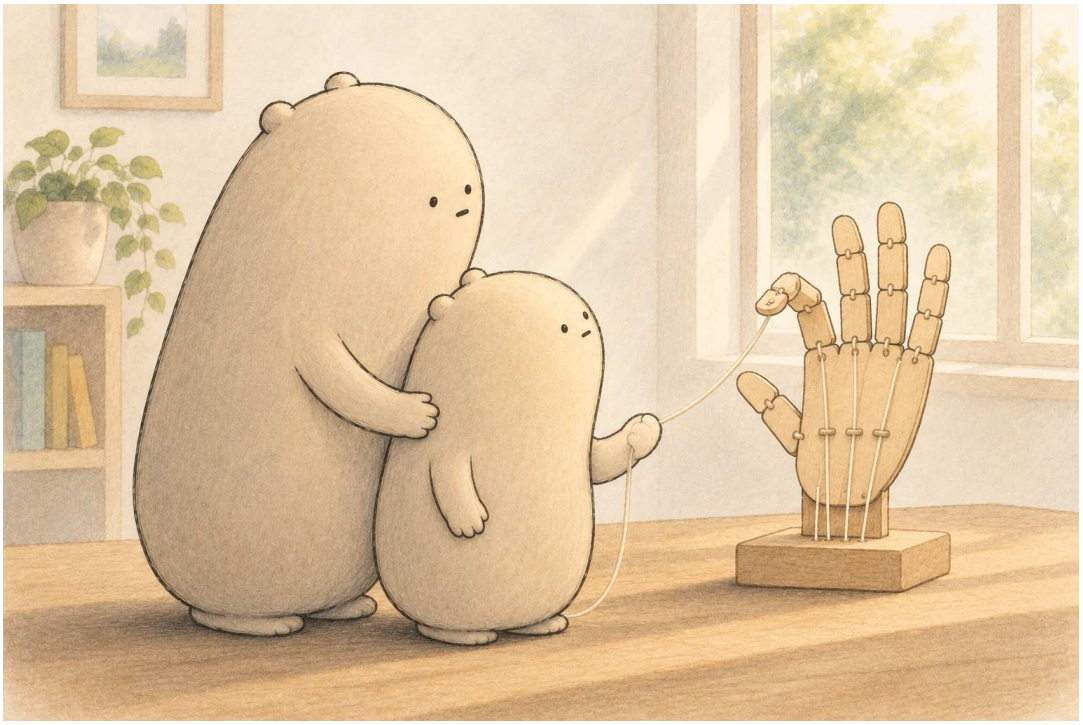
bone · tendon · joint · muscle · because · maybe

A finger stays stiff because … what is inside it?

A finger curls when … what pulls on it?

A finger opens again because … what can a muscle not do?

Does your sentence tell what you noticed and use because or maybe to explain?



Who Pulls My Strings?

Little Wonderer pulled on a string, only one,
and a toy finger curled like a cat in the sun.
"Who's pulling MY fingers?" the little one cried.
"I don't see a string, and I've looked on each side!"

Big Wonderer laughed. "You have strings, it is true.
They're tendons, tucked under your skin, out of view.
Your muscles sit up in your arm past your wrist,
and they tug, and they tug, till your fingers make fists."

Inside every finger are three bones in a row
(the thumb has just two, as the toy seemed to know),
with joints in between them that fold like a door —
just one way, not backward. (Please don't try for more.)

But muscles can't push, so to open back wide,
there are strings on the back, on the knuckle-y side.
So the little one waved at the toy on the shelf:
"We both work on strings — but I pull them myself!"